Foam rolling — lower body rest day (hEDS / HSD safe)

Myofascial release only · no joint mobilization · matched to lower body routine · ~15 min · 6 areas

Target area

Glutes · Hamstrings · Calves · Quads · TFL / hip · Adductors

⚠ hEDS / HSD foam rolling rules

Roll on muscle bellies only — never on joints, tendons, or bony prominences. Never roll over the knee joint or kneecap. Wall-based ball work preferred for pressure control. Tennis ball first.

Phase 1 — Glutes + posterior chain (~6 min)

1 **Glutes (seated on roller, crossed-leg)** — 1–2 min per side · Foam roller · ~3 min

Gluteus maximus · gluteus medius — loaded by hip thrusts (ex. 5)
Sit on roller, cross one ankle over opposite knee, lean into elevated side.
Roll glute belly in small movements. Find 2–3 tender spots per side.
hEDS: stay on muscle belly — avoid sitting bone and hip joint. Adjust lean for pressure.

2 **Hamstrings (seated on roller)** — 1–2 min per side · Foam roller · ~3 min

Biceps femoris · semimembranosus · semitendinosus
— loaded by DB RDLs, prone curls (ex. 3, 7)
Sit with roller under back of thigh. Rotate foot in/out to hit
inner and outer hamstring heads. Pause 20–30s on tender spots.
hEDS: stay well above the back of the knee — never roll over the knee joint.

Phase 2 — Calves + quads (~6 min)

3 **Calves (seated on roller)** — 1–2 min per side · Foam roller · ~3 min

Gastrocnemius · soleus — loaded by standing + seated calf raises (ex. 8, 9)
Sit with roller under calves. Rotate foot in/out to target
medial and lateral gastrocnemius heads + soleus.
hEDS: stay on muscle belly — avoid Achilles tendon and back of knee.

4 **Quads (prone on roller)** — 1–2 min per side · Foam roller · ~3 min

Vastus medialis · vastus lateralis · rectus femoris
— loaded by sit-to-stands, wall sits (ex. 6, 4)
Face down, roller under front of thigh. Rotate leg in/out to hit
inner (VMO) and outer (VL) portions. Pause 20–30s on tender spots.
hEDS: stop well above the kneecap — never roll over the patella.

Phase 3 — Hip detail (~3 min)

5 **TFL + hip flexor area (ball against wall)** — 30–40s per side · Tennis ball · ~2 min

Tensor fasciae latae — stabilizer for all standing work, feeds into IT band
Tennis ball on front/side of hip, just below hip bone. Small circles,
gentle lean. Tight TFL pulls on IT band → affects patellar tracking.
hEDS: very light pressure — stay on the small muscular area, avoid the hip bone itself.

6 **Adductors (prone frog position on roller)** — 40s–1 min per side · Foam roller · ~2 min

Adductor longus · magnus · brevis — stabilizers during all bilateral lower body work
Face down, one leg out to side with knee bent, roller along inner thigh.
Roll gently from mid-thigh toward groin, stopping short of groin crease.
hEDS: very gentle pressure — stay mid-belly, avoid groin attachment and knee.

Quick reference — exercise ↔ foam rolling map

Hip thrusts	→ Glutes (#1), Hamstrings (#2)
DB Romanian deadlift / prone curls	→ Hamstrings (#2), Glutes (#1)
Standing / seated calf raises	→ Calves (#3)
Sit-to-stand / wall sits	→ Quads (#4), TFL (#5)
All standing lower body work	→ TFL (#5), Adductors (#6)
Banded lateral walks / clamshells	→ Glutes (#1), TFL (#5), Adductors (#6)

hEDS / HSD foam rolling rules — every session

- Roll on muscle bellies only — never on joints, tendons, bony prominences, or the kneecap
- Wall-based ball work preferred for TFL — gives you full pressure control vs floor-based
- Use tennis ball first — upgrade to lacrosse ball only after 3–4 weeks of known tolerance
- At 58kg no extra loading needed — your bodyweight provides sufficient pressure
- Never roll over the knee joint — stop well above and below on muscle tissue only
- If any area feels MORE loose/unstable after rolling — skip it next session and tell your physio

Schedule + equipment

Rest days only (non-gym days) · ideally evening · ~15 min total
Equipment: 1 standard foam roller + 1 tennis ball (upgrade to lacrosse ball after 3–4 weeks)
This is soft tissue work only — your CARs / iso holds / mobility protocol stays on gym days